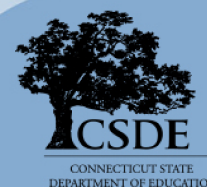


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



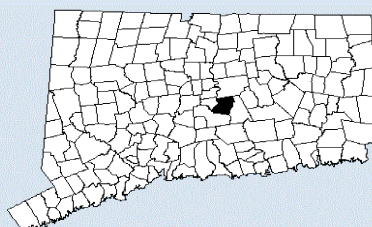
Portland School District

Dr. Charles Britton, Superintendent • 860-342-6790 • <http://www.portlandctschools.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	5
Enrollment	1,279
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$17,014
Total Expenditures ¹	\$23,156,087

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.4
Male	663	51.8	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.3
Asian	24	1.9	5.2
Black or African American	36	2.8	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	198	15.5	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	72	5.6	4.0
White	949	74.2	49.9
English Learners	43	3.4	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	372	29.1	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	195	15.2	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	77	12.7	8	1.3
Male	91	14.2	17	2.5
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	43	23.4	*	*
White	87	9.3	17	1.7
English Learners	12	29.3	0	0.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	106	34.6	15	3.9
Students with Disabilities	62	30.4	10	4.2
District	168	13.5	25	1.9
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 21

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Portland School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	93.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	4.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	17.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	34.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	5.3
School Level	5.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	4.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	2.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	10.0
School Nurses	5.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	59.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.3
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	0.0	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	139	100.0	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	6.3	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	9	*	9	*
White	65	82.3	80	95.2
English Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	18	90.0	16	*
Students with Disabilities	6	*	15	*
District	82	85.4	98	96.1
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	10	45.5
Emotional Disturbance	*	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	56	88.9
Other Health Impairment	30	65.2
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	21	91.3
District	124	72.1
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Portland School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	23	1.8	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.5
Learning Disability	63	4.9	5.8
Other Health Impairment	49	3.8	3.3
Other Disabilities	12	0.9	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	26	2.0	1.9
All Disabilities	185	14.3	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$13,661,939	\$10,038	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$1,304,628	\$1,004	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$552,269	\$425	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$1,395,310	\$1,073	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$1,674,341	\$1,288	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$252,526	\$194	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$3,005,498	\$2,312	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$985,417	\$916	\$1,159
Food services	\$40,963	\$32	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$283,196	\$218	\$151
Total	\$23,156,087	\$17,014	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$1,289,093	26.5	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$721,386	14.8	11.1
Other Salaries	\$400,118	8.2	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$798,584	16.4	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$443,352	9.1	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$940,377	19.3	22.5
Supplies	\$32,644	0.7	0.5
Property Services	\$3,702	0.1	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$215,518	4.4	7.2
Equipment	\$15,564	0.3	0.2
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$4,860,338	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		21.0	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	74.3
State	23.9
Federal	1.7
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Portland School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Portland School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	6	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
English Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	24	83.3
Students with Disabilities	14	*
District	91	92.3
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	96.1	46	44.7
Male	93.7	47	49.5
Black or African American	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino	*	*	*
White	96.3	83	50.9
English Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	88.9	*	*
Students with Disabilities	73.1	0	0.0
District	94.9	93	47.0
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

Copyright © 2021 The College Board. www.collegeboard.org

ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

Copyright © International Baccalaureate Organization 2021

* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	83.7	95.5
Male	59.1	70.3
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	72.5	83.8
English Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	54.5	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	71.3	84.0
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Portland School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	13.5%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	29.8%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	90.9%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	47.0%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		85.8%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		92.3%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		92.3%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		71.2%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		73.0%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	92.3%	1.7%	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Portland School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Over the past several years, including the 2020-21 school year, Portland Public Schools has extensively strengthened our special education services and multi-tiered systems of support for students with disabilities across the district. We have built and implemented within each of our five school buildings therapeutic alternative day programs that have significantly reduced the need for special education outplacements. Additionally, we have recently hired a full-time applied behavioral analyst who both provides services to students in need and collaborates with classroom staff to continually strengthen behavior management and social emotional instruction for all students. In 2020-21, the district also added in multiple additional full-time special education teachers, a full-time therapeutic clinician, and several paraprofessionals to further support students and programs. Over the past twelve-plus months, the district has made strategic use of consultative services to provide professional development and guidance to all staff on research-based best practices in behavioral science. The efforts described above have helped us to continually improve our comprehensive array of support services, which enable our students with disabilities to meet success within least restrictive environments across Portland Public Schools.

Portland Public schools actively monitors student attendance and strategically intervenes when patterns of absence interfere with a students' social, academic, and personal success. Such interventions occur most specifically when a student is on track to miss more than four days of school in a single calendar month or ten school days for the entire year. Throughout the district, we have strong SRBI processes and protocols in place that school counselors, social workers, teachers, and administrators use to develop specific, measurable support plans that promote student attendance. To further support high levels of student attendance and engagement, each of our five buildings maintains a school climate committee that strives to create a positive school climate inclusive, inviting, and supportive of all students. The district continues to make significant strides in reducing instances of discipline, suspension, and expulsion through the use of restorative practices and a focus on building and preserving positive, healthy relationships. In 2020-21, Portland Public Schools applied for and was accepted into the Connecticut School-Based Diversion Initiative (SBDI), a CSDE-sponsored, grant-funded program which seeks to advance restorative practices within school settings in order to reduce exclusionary disciplinary practices. We are excited to undertake this work with SBDI beginning in the 2021-22 school year.

Portland Public Schools publishes weekly newsletters that help to keep families abreast of school happenings, including important events, information, and opportunities. Teachers produce progress reports each marking period, which are sent home to parents/guardians for review. Each school has active PTO committees and various booster clubs. The district strategically involves parent representatives on hiring committees and regularly solicits parental feedback. Regularly scheduled curriculum nights, literacy nights, STEM nights, and arts exhibitions help us maintain strong connections with our parents and families.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Portland Public Schools actively participates in state-wide and locally-offered programs that promote and sustain diversity, equity, and inclusion. In 2020-21, twenty-three students who reside in Hartford attended Portland Public Schools via the Open Choice program, one PPS student attended the Greater Hartford Academy of the Arts, and twenty-two students participated in courses offered by Connecticut's Virtual High School program.

Minority teacher recruitment is a critical initiative in Portland. Portland Public Schools maintains a strategic partnership with TEACH Connecticut, a platform designed to guide and inform aspiring educators towards public school employment within the state. Additionally, our district regularly participates in local teacher recruitment fairs. Minority candidates we meet via fairs and through our strategic partnerships with organizations such as TEACH Connecticut are given priority consideration within our hiring processes.

Portland Public Schools offers all students PreK-12 robust curricula that prioritizes inclusivity for all and representation of historically underrepresented groups. Social justice is a critical component of social studies and language arts coursework and related content. Students wrestle with essential questions and emerge with enduring understandings associated with our nation's and the world's ongoing struggles against forces of racism, discrimination, intolerance, and inhumanity. In all facets of their education, students are taught the skills and practices necessary to engage in civil discourse with others and to practice tolerance and respect for others, even when their perspectives, experiences, and beliefs are different from one's own.

In 2020-21, Portland Public Schools launched the Portland Public Schools Equity and Inclusion Coalition. Composed of varied representatives from across our district (teachers, students, parents, BOE members, administrators, and support staff), this group meets monthly with the purpose of surfacing inequities within our schools and school community and partnering with our schools and district to repair such injustices. We will be engaging in the year ahead in comprehensive equity and inclusion audits across all facets and systems of Portland Public Schools.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Portland School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Portland Public Schools ensures the equitable allocation of resources among district schools through a collaborative budget development process that engages a wide variety of community representatives. Each school receives a baseline per pupil expenditure that ensures funds are distributed equitably. Each school and department is also provided the opportunity to advocate for funding to support school improvement initiatives. District leaders, building principals, team leaders, and curriculum specialists work collaboratively to prioritize resources and maximize the benefit of district funds. The funding priorities are then vetted by the Portland Board of Education, and ultimately are subject to community approval through the referendum process.

In addition to the regular budgeting process, supplemental funding exists through several grant programs, including the Perkins Grant, Gildersleeve Wheeler Grant, Ryan Fund, Title grants, and other opportunities. Portland utilizes all sources of grant funding at our disposal to obtain and equitably allocate resources across our schools and in service to all learners.